UNIT-4
REPORTS

Reports

- A report is a major form of technical/business/professional communication.
- In writing a report a person who possesses certain facts , ideas, or suggestions useful for course of action transmits this information to another person who wants to use it.
- A report can be the description of an event by a person
- It **is usually a piece of factual writing , based on evidence, containing organized information on a particular topic and/ or analysis of that particular topic.**
- It is formal in nature and written for a specific purpose and audience.

Reports :Objectives

- To present a record of accomplished **work(Project Report**)
- -To record an experiment (**research / lab report)**
- -To record research findings (**details of a new product**)
- -To document schedules , **time-tables, and milestones(long term plans)**
- -To document current status(**an inspection report**)
- -to record and clarify complex information for future reference(a **report on policies and procedure**)
- -to present information to a large number of **people(annual report)**
- -to present organized information on a particular topic: describing working of various **divisions of an organization**)
- -To recommend actions that can be considered in solving certain problems(**recommendatory reports**)

Characteristics of Reports

- **1.Precision**:Effective reports clearly reflect their purpose . Precision gives unity and coherence to your report and makes it a valuable document
- **2.Factual details** : Your report should be very detailed and factual. The scientific accuracy of facts is very essential to a good report. As the reports lead to decision making , inaccurate facts may lead to disastrous decisions.
- **3.Relevance:**The facts presented in a report should be not only accurate but also relevant. Irrelevant facts make a report confusing, exclusion of relevant facts renders it incomplete and is likely to mislead.
- **4.Reader Orientation:** A good report is always reader oriented While drafting a report , it is necessary to keep in mind the person(s) who is(are) going to read it.
- **5.Objectivity of recommendation :** If recommendations are made at the end of a report , they must be impartial and objective. They must not reveal any self- interest on the part of the writer.

Characteristics of Reports

- **6.Simple and unambiguous language:** It is document of practical utility. It should be clear, brief, and grammatically accurate.
- **7.Special Format :**It should include- cover, title page, table of contents, list of illustrations, letter of transmittal, and appendices. To be prepared according to set standards.
- **8.Illustrations:** Illustrations may be -tables, graphs, maps, drawings, charts, or photographs.
- **9. Homogeneity :** Your report should deal with one topic at a time . All the sections of your report should focus on that topic.
- **10.Documentation:** Technical reports acquire more value when adequately documented by acknowledging the sources of information in an appropriate style.

Types of Reports

- On the basis of **Purpose , frequency , or mode** of reporting, reports can be classified as follows:
- **i) Informative, Analytical (purpose)**
- **ii) Periodic, Special (Frequency) (Time duration, time intervals)**
- **iii) Oral, Written (Mode of presentation)**
- **i)Informative Reports**:
- The purpose of Information report is to present the information in an objective, factual, and organized manner.
- It presents the situation simply as it is .
- To write an information report , to collect data, arrange it in an appropriate order and present it in a style appropriate to technical writing.
- Various sections are simple and self explanatory
- Recommendations do not arise in this type of report.
- **eg.: a report to trace the growth of company x in the automobile industry. Present action of all details in chronological order**

Types of Report

- **Analytical Report:**
- It is also known as interpretative or investigative report.
- **If a report analyses the facts, draws conclusion , and makes recommendation , it is described as analytical report.**
- **For instance** : a report which presents production figures for a particular period is **informative**. But if it goes into the causes of lower production in that period , it **becomes analytical, interpretative or investigative**.
- The analytical report **comprises stages in which** there is
- i) a proper identification of problem, ii)analysis, and iii) subsequent interpretation.
- Recommendations or suggestions are then incorporated In the report, depending upon what is required by the report writer . In a problem solving method the **following steps are observed** :
- Drafting problem statement
- Evolving Criteria
- Suggesting alternatives and evaluation
- Drawing conclusion(s) and making recommendations.
- **Patterns: Inductive and Deductive Methods**

Types of Reports

- **ii) <u>Periodic , Special</u> Report(frequency)**
- **Periodic or routine reports** are either informational or analytical in their purpose.
- **As they are prepared and presented at regular , prescribed intervals in the usual routine of business they are called periodic or routine reports.**
- They may be submitted annually, semi- annually, quarterly, monthly, fortnightly , weekly, or daily.
- Progress reports of various kinds , inspection reports, annual reports, and sales report all come under this category.
- At times the routine reports can be analytical or interpretative.

Types of Reports

- **Special Reports:**
- These are related to single occasion or situation.
- **eg-A report on the feasibility of opening a new branch , on the unrest among staff in a particular branch,** or ,
- **Eg-the causes behind the recent fire incidents in a factory are special reports**.
- Special reports deal with non- recurrent problems.

Types of Reports

- iii) **Oral and Written Reports(mode of reporting)**
- Reports can be oral or written depending upon the mode of presentation.
- Eg-When you rejoin duty after attending an international seminar , you meet your officer and report about the deliberations of the seminar . This type of reporting comes under oral reporting.
- An Oral report is simple and easy to present . It may communicate an impression or an observation.
- Written reports are preferred as they enjoy several advantages over the oral ones.

Difference between Oral and Written Report.

- **Oral Report.**
- -Immediate feedback is possible
- -Do not add to permanent records of organization
- -Audience needs to comprehend quickly
- -Relevant facts may be overlooked
- -Cannot be referred again and again
- - Have less professional value
- **Written Report**
- -Immediate feedback not possible
- -permanent records of organization
- -Audience can think and understand at their own space
- -More accurate and precise
- -can be edited, reviewed, stored , and retrieved
- -more professional value

Importance of Reports

- i)It is the only tangible product of a professional
- ii)It enables decision making and problem solving in organization
- iii)Helps authorities in planning new ventures and in evaluating men and material
- iv)It an important means of information dissemination
- v)It serves as measure of the growth , progress, or success of an organization
- vi) It is valuable repository of information
- vii)Reports reveal gaps in thinking
- vii) Reports develop certain skills in the writer